

GAMING AS WE KNOW IT IS NEVER GOING TO BE THE SAME AGAIN, FROM THIS YEAR ONWARDS. ARE YOU READY FOR THE CHANGE?

By Manish “Trigger Happy” Rajesh



What's common between the Mona Lisa, the Sistine Chapel and the telescope? They were all made during the Renaissance – a time of cultural, intellectual and creative awakening in Europe at an unprecedented degree. A watershed moment of the same magnitude is unravelling in the world of gaming this year. Much like the innovators and trendsetters of the European Renaissance that inspired a generation and beyond, this year has been a big one for gaming and it came with some big news which could forever change the way we game in the near future. These changes have been spoken about and mentioned several times in the past, but we've never quite been this close to the moment we've all been waiting for. We're at the edge of a revolution and the face of gaming could forever change.

VIRTUAL REALITY

Just like Michelangelo painted the ceiling of the Sistine Chapel stroke-by-stroke to give our eyes a masterpiece to gape at, it's been a painstakingly determined journey among the trendsetters of gaming to usher in the dawn of modern VR in 2016. You may not know it, but this isn't the first time VR hype has taken over the world. It's happened before, a good 20 years ago in fact. But what VR represented back then wasn't quite as complex as today. Just the arrival of 3D models in games was considered virtual reality back then, and well it was kind of the dawn of a new age in gaming back then too. This was when we first saw games like the legendary



Doom which is considered one of the most important games ever made. Now you can understand why we're so concerned about VR being the hype again, are we going to see a new age of gaming dawn upon us?

The possibilities with VR are endless, but we're not quite at that point where

we can actually say that VR is what we expected or wanted from it. The kind of VR we want is the kind that completely immerses us into the game or movie or whatever it is that we want to experience, where you feel like you're one of the character yourself. You want to live the character, experience it first hand, and from whatever we've seen of VR so far, it's not even close. But that doesn't mean it's not a possibility, we're just not there yet. But honestly, in our opinion we better get there fast, because wearing VR headsets worth \$600 isn't worth "not even close".

PLAYSTATION VR

However, this didn't stop Sony from